SENA KAPLAN

Department of Sociology • Randall Hall, University of Virginia
Charlottesville, VA 22903
zmu4uw@virginia.edu

EDUCATION

PhD in Sociology
University of Virginia, Charlottesville 2023–present

MA in Sociology
University of Virginia, Charlottesville 2023–2025
Thesis: *Between Aesthetics and Memory: Integrating Sociological Literatures on Art and Commemoration*

MA in Sociology
Marmara University, Istanbul, Turkey 2018–2021
Thesis: *Post-Conflict Memorialization in Turkey and the Role of Civil Society*

BSc in Sociology
Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey 2013–2018

Erasmus+ Exchange
Modern University for Business and Science, Beirut, Lebanon Spring 2017

Summer University
Humboldt Universität zu Berlin, Germany Summer 2015
Course Title: *Berlin Wall: Tales of Division and Unity*

PUBLICATIONS

Book Chapter

Kaplan, Sena. (2025) "Migration, Identity, and Cultural Memory: Social Construction of Kurdishness in Bala-Ankara." Chapter 6 in *The Kurds of Central Anatolia: The History, Identity and Future of a Forgotten People*, edited by Mehmet Gurses and Haci Cevik. London: I.B. Tauris / Bloomsbury.

Journal Article

Zang, Yingyu & Kaplan, Sena. (2026) "'AI is NOT Amazing': Academic Elitism and the Challenge of AI" *Journal of Chinese Sociology 13*(1). [Forthcoming]

Public Facing Writing

Kaplan, Sena. (2022) "Post-Conflict Memorialization Practices in Turkish Civil Society" *Demos Research Collective Blog*

Kaplan, Sena. (2018) "Kurds of Central Anatolia: Past and Present" *Kurdish History*, vol. 33.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

"Unbordering the Self: Artistic Agency and Making of New Kurdish Subjectivity" April 2026
Pacific Sociological Association Annual Conference, Long Beach, CA
'AI is NOT Amazing': Academic Elitism and the Challenge of AI" March 2026
Eastern Sociological Society Annual Conference, DC
"Unbordering the Self: Artistic Agency and Making of Kurdish Subjectivity" November 2025

FIRES, Feminist, Intersectional, Race and Ethnic Studies Workshop, UVA

"From Illicit Documents to Digital Memoryscapes: Memory Activism and Civil Society Archives in Turkey" July 2024

Memory Studies Association Annual Conference, Lima, Peru

"Resisting the Eradication of Memory: The Opportunities Created by Archives" September 2022

Demos Research Collective Panel Discussion, Ankara Turkey

"Enforced Disappearances Database as a Virtual Counter-monument" June 2022

(Re)thinking Counter-monuments: The Evolution of "Memory against itself" Online Colloquium, University of Leeds, UK

"Story of a 500 Year Migration: Kurds of Central Anatolia" April 2016

Migrations to Anatolia Conference

METU Sociology Students Conference December 2015

Istanbul University Anthropology Students Conference May 2015

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Praxis Program Fellowship, University of Virginia Scholars' Lab, 2026-2027 Academic Year

Supports participation in a training program in the international digital humanities

Conference Participation Grant, University of Virginia Department of Sociology, Summer 2024

Supported conference presentation at Memory Studies Association Annual Conference, Lima Peru

Erasmus+ Exchange Grant, Middle East Technical University, Spring 2017

Supported semester exchange at Modern University for Business and Science, Beirut Lebanon

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia, Department of Sociology, Charlottesville Virginia

Graduate Teaching Assistant Fall 2024–present

Courses: SOC 1010: Introduction to Sociology; SOC 3020: Introduction to Social Theory

Istanbul Şehir University, Department of Sociology, Istanbul Turkey

Teaching Assistant 2018–2020

Courses: Understanding Cultural Encounters; Exploring Istanbul; Understanding Society and Culture

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ASRA – Association of Assistance, Solidarity and Support for Refugees and Asylum-Seekers

Livelihood Officer 2022–present

Developed and implemented livelihood programs; managed grants, proposals, and donor relations with UN and EU programs and embassies; conducted market assessments; liaised with public authorities including municipalities and provincial ministries.

Kırkayak Culture, Arts and Nature Association

Culture and Arts Program Coordinator 2020–2021

Grants' management, proposal development, and donor relations; qualitative and quantitative research and reporting; fundraising; program monitoring and evaluation.

Kırkayak Center for Migration and Cultural Studies, Gaziantep

Research Intern 2018–2019

Istanbul Bilgi University, Center for Migration Research
Research Intern Summer 2017

Union of Municipalities, Turkey
Research Intern Summer 2019

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Department of Sociology Colloquium Committee, UVA Sociology Department, Charlottesville
Student Representative, 2025-present

International Students Advocacy Committee, UVA Sociology Department, Charlottesville
Co-Chair, 2025-present

Zeugma International Film Festival, Gaziantep Turkey
Organizational Committee Member, 2018–2023

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Turkish — Native

Kurdish (Kurmanji Dialect) — Native

English — Fluent (IELTS 8)

Persian — Good reading and writing knowledge, limited speaking

Arabic — Elementary

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SPSS (Advanced) • STATA (Advanced) • Microsoft Office (Advanced) • Adobe Photoshop (Advanced)
ATLAS.ti (Intermediate) • Qualitative and quantitative research methods • Project management